

SEPARATION PROCESSES II

CHE F313 · Problems and Solutions · I-Semester 2026-27

Every numerical question in the uploaded material, with its solution

Part A: lecture decks · Part B: tutorials · Part C: quiz and tutorial test

Every question below is quoted from one of the uploaded files, and every solution uses the method taught in the lecture that set it. The questions are grouped by source:

- **Part A — lecture decks** (Slides/): Mod 1 Lec 2, Mod 1 Lec 3, Mod 1 Lec 4, Mod 1 Lec 5, Mod 2 Lec 1.
- **Part B — tutorials** (Tutorials/): Tutorial 3 (01-09-2026), Tutorial 4 (07-09-2026).
- **Part C — tests** (Tests/): Quiz-1 (03-09-2026), Tutorial Test 1 (07-09-2026).

Question inventory

ID	Source	Topic	Solved at
Q1	Mod 1 Lec 3, slide 10	Clay catalyst: differential & cumulative analysis, A_w , $\overline{D}_s$, particle count	p. 2
Q2	Mod 1 Lec 3, slides 11–12 (table on 12)	Crushed quartz: A_w , N_w , $\overline{D}_v$, $\overline{D}_s$, $\overline{D}_w$, N_i , number fraction	p. 3
Q3	Mod 1 Lec 4, slide 19	Muller mixer: mixing index I_p and standard deviation	p. 5
Q4	Mod 1 Lec 5, slide 20	Crusher power by Rittinger's law	p. 6
Q5	Mod 2 Lec 1, slide 16	Quartz screened at 10 mesh: D/F , B/F , overall effectiveness E	p. 7
Q6	Tutorial 3, Problem 1	Sieve analysis: differential & cumulative curves, D_{50} , particle counts, A_w	p. 8
Q7	Tutorial 3, Problem 2	Shape factor and sphericity of an irregular particle	p. 10
Q8	Tutorial 4, Problem 1	Crusher power when capacity and product size change	p. 11
Q9	Tutorial 4, Problem 2	Energy per kg of material (Kick's law)	p. 11
Q10	Quiz-1, 03-09-2026	Mixing index of a binary solid mixture from ten samples	p. 13
Q11	Tutorial Test 1, 07-09-2026	Bond work index and the power for a finer product	p. 13

Parts of Q2, Q6, Q7, Q8, Q9 and Q11 sit inside pictures on the source slides rather than in their text; those parts were read from the pictures and are quoted as printed. Where a source leaves something undefined, the note at the end of that solution says so instead of filling it in.

Q1 — Screen analysis of a clay catalyst

Module 1 · Lecture 3 · slide 10

Source: Slides/Mod1-Lecture 3.pptx, slide 10 (“Problem 1: Screen Analysis”)

“Finely divided clay is used as a catalyst in the petroleum industry. It has density of 1.2 g/cc and a sphericity of 0.5. The size analysis is as follows:”

D_{pi} / mm	0.0252	0.0178	0.0126	0.0089	0.0038
x_i (g/g)	0.088	0.178	0.293	0.194	0.247

“Show the differential & cumulative screen analysis of the mixture. Find the specific surface area and the Sauter mean diameter of the clay material. Find the number of particles in 1 g sample.”

Method from the slides. Specific surface area and mean diameters (Mod 1 Lec 3):

$$A_w = \frac{6}{\rho_p \Phi_s} \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}}, \quad \bar{D}_s = \frac{1}{\sum_i x_i / D_{pi}} = \frac{6}{\Phi_s \rho_p A_w}, \quad N_w = \frac{1}{a \rho_p} \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}^3}$$

Cumulative analysis is built by adding the increments consecutively, starting from the smallest particles (Mod 1 Lec 2, slide 16).

Solution

1. Differential and cumulative analysis. The differential analysis is the tabulated x_i against D_{pi} . The cumulative “fraction smaller than D_{pi} ” is the running sum from the smallest size; “fraction larger” is its complement. Check: $\sum x_i = 1.000$.

D_{pi} / mm	x_i	cumulative smaller	cumulative larger
0.0038	0.247	0.2470	0.7530
0.0089	0.194	0.4410	0.5590
0.0126	0.293	0.7340	0.2660
0.0178	0.178	0.9120	0.0880
0.0252	0.088	1.0000	0.0000

2. Specific surface area and Sauter mean diameter. With $\rho_p = 1.2 \text{ g/cm}^3 = 1.2 \times 10^{-3} \text{ g/mm}^3$ and $\Phi_s = 0.5$:

$$\sum_i \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}} = 123.544 \text{ mm}^{-1}, \quad A_w = \frac{6}{(1.2 \times 10^{-3})(0.5)} (123.544) = 1.2354 \times 10^6 \text{ mm}^2/\text{g} = 1.24 \text{ m}^2/\text{g}$$

$$\bar{D}_s = \frac{1}{123.544} = 0.008094 \text{ mm} = 8.09 \text{ }\mu\text{m}$$

3. Number of particles in a 1 g sample. With $\sum x_i / D_{pi}^3 = 4.9601 \times 10^6 \text{ mm}^{-3}$,

$$N_w = \frac{1}{a \rho_p} \sum_i \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}^3} = \frac{4.9601 \times 10^6}{a(1.2 \times 10^{-3})} = \frac{4.133 \times 10^9}{a} \text{ particles per gram}$$

For spheres, $a = \pi/6 = 0.5236$, giving $N_w = 7.89 \times 10^9 \text{ particles/g}$.

(a) $\sum x_i = 1.000$; differential and cumulative tables as above.

(b) $A_w = 1.2354 \times 10^6 \text{ mm}^2/\text{g} = 1.24 \text{ m}^2/\text{g}$; $\bar{D}_s = 8.09 \text{ }\mu\text{m}$.

(c) $N_w = (4.133 \times 10^9)/a \text{ particles per gram}$; with $a = \pi/6$, $N_w \approx 7.9 \times 10^9 \text{ particles/g}$.

Note. The slide does not give the volume shape factor a (unlike Q2, where $a = 0.8$ is stated). The value above assumes the sphere value $a = \pi/6$. Since $N_w \propto 1/a$, quoting a from the question paper changes the answer: $a = 0.5 \rightarrow 8.3 \times 10^9/\text{g}$, $a = 0.8 \rightarrow 5.2 \times 10^9/\text{g}$. Confirm the intended a before submitting.

Source: Slides/Mod1-Lecture 3.pptx, slides 11–12 (“Problem 2: Screen Analysis”; the table sits on slide 12, headed Numerical Problem, and the same table appears on Lecture 2 slide 17)

“The screen analysis shown in Table applies to a sample of crushed quartz. The density of the particles is 2650 kg/m³ (0.00265 g/mm³), and the shape factors are $a = 0.8$ and $\Phi_s = 0.571$. For the material between 4-mesh and 200-mesh in particle size, calculate (a) A_w in square millimeters per gram and N_w in particles per gram, (b) D_v (c) D_s (d) D_w and (e) N_i for the 150/200-mesh increment. (f) What fraction of the total number of particles is in the 150/200-mesh increment?”

Table as printed on slide 12. Columns: mesh, screen opening, mass fraction retained x_i , average particle diameter in increment, cumulative fraction smaller than D_{pi} .

Mesh	opening / mm	retained x_i	D_{pi} in increment / mm	cumulative smaller
4	4.699	0.0000	—	1.0000
6	3.327	0.0251	4.013	0.9749
8	2.362	0.1250	2.845	0.8499
10	1.651	0.3207	2.007	0.5292
14	1.168	0.2570	1.409	0.2722
20	0.833	0.1590	1.001	0.1132
28	0.589	0.0538	0.711	0.0594
35	0.417	0.0210	0.503	0.0384
48	0.295	0.0102	0.356	0.0282
65	0.208	0.0077	0.252	0.0205
100	0.147	0.0058	0.178	0.0147
150	0.104	0.0041	0.126	0.0106
200	0.074	0.0031	0.089	0.0075
Pan	—	0.0075	0.037	0.0000

Method from the slides.

$$A_w = \frac{6}{\rho_p \Phi_s} \sum \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}}, \quad N_w = \frac{1}{a \rho_p} \sum \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}^3}, \quad \bar{D}_v = \left[\frac{1}{\sum x_i / D_{pi}^3} \right]^{1/3}, \quad \bar{D}_s = \frac{1}{\sum x_i / D_{pi}}, \quad \bar{D}_w = \sum x_i D_{pi}$$

and, for one increment, $N_i = \frac{x_i}{a \rho_p \bar{D}_{pi}^3}$ per unit mass of the whole sample.

Solution

Check of the table. Each increment diameter is the mean of its two defining screen openings, rounded to the three decimals printed: $(4.699 + 3.327)/2 = 4.013$, $(3.327 + 2.362)/2 = 2.845$, ..., $(0.074 + 0)/2 = 0.037$ for the pan. All 13 values agree to within 0.0005 mm.

The two sums (12 increments, 4-mesh to 200-mesh; pan excluded, since the question says “between 4-mesh and 200-mesh”):

$$\sum_{i=1}^{12} \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}} = 0.82780 \text{ mm}^{-1}, \quad \sum_{i=1}^{12} \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}^3} = 8.7932 \text{ mm}^{-3}$$

(work for the first increment, $D_{pi} = 4.013$, $x_i = 0.0251$: $0.0251/4.013 = 0.00626$ and $0.0251/4.013^3 = 0.000389$.)

(a)

$$A_w = \frac{6}{(2.65 \times 10^{-3})(0.571)} (0.82780) = 3282 \text{ mm}^2/\text{g} = 32.8 \text{ cm}^2/\text{g},$$

$$N_w = \frac{8.7932}{(0.8)(2.65 \times 10^{-3})} = 4148 \text{ particles/g}.$$

(b)–(d) $\bar{D}_v = [1/8.7932]^{1/3} = 0.4845 \text{ mm}$; $\bar{D}_s = 1/0.82780 = 1.2080 \text{ mm}$; $\bar{D}_w = \sum x_i D_{pi} = 1.6775 \text{ mm}$.

(e) For the 150/200-mesh increment $x_i = 0.0031$ and $D_{pi} = 0.089 \text{ mm}$:

$$N_i = \frac{0.0031}{(0.8)(2.65 \times 10^{-3})(0.089)^3} = 2074 \text{ particles/g}$$

(f) The share of all particles in that increment is its share of $\sum x_i / D_{pi}^3$:

$$\frac{N_i}{N_T} = \frac{0.0031/0.089^3}{8.7932} = 0.5001 \approx 50\%$$

Compare its *mass* fraction, $x_i = 0.31\%$: half of all the particles sit in this one fine increment although it is a negligible part of the mass.

- (a) $A_w = 3282 \text{ mm}^2/\text{g}$, $N_w = 4148 \text{ particles/g}$.
(b) $\bar{D}_v = 0.484 \text{ mm}$. (c) $\bar{D}_s = 1.208 \text{ mm}$. (d) $\bar{D}_w = 1.677 \text{ mm}$.
(e) $N_i = 2074 \text{ particles/g}$. (f) $N_i/N_T = 0.500$ — about **50%** of all particles, against 0.31% of the mass.

Notes.

- **Scope.** Excluding the pan gives $\sum x_i = 0.9925$, so the sums are not normalised to one. Including the pan instead gives $A_w = 4086 \text{ mm}^2/\text{g}$, $N_w = 73\,990 \text{ particles/g}$, $\bar{D}_v = 0.185 \text{ mm}$, $\bar{D}_s = 0.970 \text{ mm}$, $\bar{D}_w = 1.678 \text{ mm}$ and $N_i/N_T = 2.8\%$. The exclusion follows the wording of the question.
- **Which diameter.** The increment means D_{pi} from the table are used throughout; for the 150/200 increment that is 0.089 mm, not the screen openings 0.104 or 0.074 mm.

Source: Slides/Mod1-Lecture 4.pptx, slide 19 (“Problem 1”)

“A silty soil containing 14 percent moisture was mixed in a large muller mixer with 10 wt% of a tracer consisting of dextrose and picric acid. After 3 min of mixing, 12 random samples were taken from the mix and analyzed calorimetrically for tracer material. The measured concentrations in the sample were in weight percent tracer, 10.24, 9.30, 7.94, 10.24, 11.08, 10.03, 11.91, 9.72, 9.20, 10.76, 10.97, 10.55. Calculate the mixing index IP and the standard deviation.”

Method from the slides (cohesive solids / pastes, Mod 1 Lec 4 slides 16 and 18):

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^N (x_i - \bar{x})^2}{N - 1}} = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^N x_i^2 - \bar{x} \sum_{i=1}^N x_i}{N - 1}}, \quad \sigma_0 = \sqrt{\mu(1 - \mu)}, \quad I_s = \frac{\sigma_0}{s}$$

with x_i the mass fraction of A in each sample, $\bar{x}$ their average, N the number of spot samples, and σ_0 the standard deviation at zero mixing.

Solution

$$\bar{x} = \frac{121.94}{12} = 10.1617 \text{ wt}\%, \quad \sum_{i=1}^{12} (x_i - \bar{x})^2 = 11.890 \text{ (wt}\%)^2$$

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{11.890}{12 - 1}} = 1.0397 \text{ wt}\% = 0.010397 \text{ (mass fraction)}$$

With the 10 wt% of tracer charged, $\mu = 0.10$ and

$$\sigma_0 = \sqrt{0.10 \times 0.90} = 0.30, \quad I_p = \frac{0.30}{0.010397} = 28.9$$

A value of I_p far above 1 shows a mixture much more uniform than a segregated charge, which is the expected direction as mixing proceeds.

$$\bar{x} = 10.16 \text{ wt}\%, \quad s = 1.04 \text{ wt}\% \text{ (0.0104 as a mass fraction)}, \quad \sigma_0 = 0.30, \quad I_p = 0.30/0.0104 = 28.9 \approx 29.$$

Notes.

- Using the measured mean instead of the charged composition, $\mu = \bar{x} = 0.1016$, gives $\sigma_0 = 0.3022$ and $I_p = 29.1$; using the N denominator gives $s = 0.995\%$ and $I_p = 30.1$.
- The granular-solid form $\sigma_e = \sqrt{\mu_p(1 - \mu_p)/n}$ cannot be used here: it needs n , the number of particles per sample, which the slide does not give.
- The slide writes the paste mixing index as I_s ; the question calls it I_p . They are the same quantity.

Source: Slides/Mod1-Lecture 5.pptx, slide 20 ("Problem 1: Size reduction")

"Particles of the average feed size of 50×10^{-4} m are crushed to an average product size of 10×10^{-4} m at the rate of 20 tonnes per hour. At this rate, the crusher consumes 40 kW of power which 5 kW are required for running the mill empty. Calculate the power consumption if 12 tonnes/h of this product is crushed to 5×10^{-4} m size in the same mill? Assume Rittinger's Law is applicable."

Method fixed by the slide (Mod 1 Lec 5, Rittinger's law):

$$\frac{P}{\dot{m}} = K_R \left[\frac{1}{\overline{D}_{Sb}} - \frac{1}{\overline{D}_{Sa}} \right]$$

with $\overline{D}_{Sa}$ the feed size and $\overline{D}_{Sb}$ the product size. The question directs Rittinger's law, so Kick's and Bond's laws are not used.

Solution

1. **Useful power of the first duty.** Of the 40 kW drawn, 5 kW runs the mill empty:

$$P_{\text{net},1} = 40 - 5 = 35 \text{ kW at } 20 \text{ t/h}, \quad \frac{P_{\text{net},1}}{\dot{m}_1} = 1.75 \text{ kW h/t}$$

2. **Rittinger constant of this mill and material.**

$$\frac{1}{\overline{D}_{Sb}} - \frac{1}{\overline{D}_{Sa}} = \frac{1}{10 \times 10^{-4}} - \frac{1}{50 \times 10^{-4}} = 1000 - 200 = 800/\text{m}, \quad K_R = \frac{1.75}{800} = 2.1875 \times 10^{-3} \text{ kW h m/t}$$

3. **Second duty.** The same mill now takes this product (10×10^{-4} m) down to 5×10^{-4} m at 12 t/h:

$$\frac{1}{\overline{D}_{Sb}} - \frac{1}{\overline{D}_{Sa}} = 2000 - 1000 = 1000/\text{m}, \quad P_{\text{net},2} = (2.1875 \times 10^{-3})(12)(1000) = 26.25 \text{ kW}$$

Adding back the fixed empty-mill load: $P_2 = 26.25 + 5 = 31.25 \text{ kW}$.

4. **Check by ratios.** $\frac{P_2 - 5}{P_1 - 5} = \frac{\dot{m}_2}{\dot{m}_1} \cdot \frac{1000}{800} = \frac{12}{20} \cdot 1.25 = 0.75$, so $P_2 = 5 + 0.75(35) = 31.25 \text{ kW}$ — the same value.

$K_R = 2.1875 \times 10^{-3} \text{ kW h m/t}$; net crushing power $P_{\text{net},2} = 26.25 \text{ kW}$; $P_2 = 31.25 \text{ kW}$ drawn by the crusher, including the empty-mill power.

Note. If the question is read as asking only for the *work of size reduction*, the answer is 26.25 kW; the machine's own consumption, which is what the wording asks for, is 31.25 kW because the 5 kW empty-mill load is still drawn.

Source: Slides/Mod 2-Lecture 1-compressed.pdf, slide 16 (“Problem on Screen Effectiveness”); the slide’s own worked solution is the graph on slide 18

“A quartz mixture having the screen analysis shown in Table is screened through a standard 10-mesh screen. The cumulative screen analysis of overflow and underflow are given in Table. Calculate — the mass ratios of the overflow and underflow to feed and — the overall effectiveness of the screen.”

Table as printed on slide 16 — the slide’s caption is “Screen analyses — Cumulative fraction LARGER than D_p ”, with columns Feed, Overflow, Underflow:

Mesh	D_p/mm	Feed x_F	Overflow x_D	Underflow x_B
4	4.699	0	0	
6	3.327	0.025	0.071	
8	2.362	0.15	0.43	0
10	1.651	0.47	0.85	0.195
14	1.168	0.73	0.97	0.58
20	0.833	0.885	0.99	0.83
28	0.589	0.94	1.00	0.91
35	0.417	0.96		0.94
65	0.208	0.98		0.975
Pan		1.00		1.00

Method from the slides (Mod 2 Lec 1, hand-worked slides 12–15):

$$\frac{D}{F} = \frac{x_F - x_B}{x_D - x_B}, \quad \frac{B}{F} = \frac{x_F - x_D}{x_B - x_D}, \quad E_A = \frac{Dx_D}{Fx_F}, \quad E_B = \frac{B(1 - x_B)}{F(1 - x_F)}, \quad E = E_A E_B$$

The slide’s own worked solution reads the three cumulative curves at the cut size.

Solution

The cut is the 10-mesh opening, $D_{pc} = 1.651$ mm, and the table row for 10 mesh supplies the three values directly: $x_F = 0.47$, $x_D = 0.85$, $x_B = 0.195$.

Mass ratios.

$$\frac{D}{F} = \frac{0.47 - 0.195}{0.85 - 0.195} = 0.4198, \quad \frac{B}{F} = \frac{0.47 - 0.85}{0.195 - 0.85} = 0.5802$$

Check: $D/F + B/F = 1.000$.

Direction efficiencies and overall effectiveness.

$$E_A = 0.4198 \times \frac{0.85}{0.47} = 0.7593, \quad E_B = 0.5802 \times \frac{0.805}{0.53} = 0.8812$$

$$E = E_A E_B = 0.7593 \times 0.8812 = 0.6691 \approx 66.9\%$$

The same number comes from the rearranged form on the slide: $E = \frac{0.85}{0.47} \cdot \frac{0.275}{0.655} \left[1 - \frac{0.15}{0.53} \cdot \frac{0.275}{0.655} \right] = 0.6691$.

$$\frac{D}{F} = 0.42 \text{ (overflow/feed)}, \quad \frac{B}{F} = 0.58 \text{ (underflow/feed)},$$

$$E_A = 0.759, \quad E_B = 0.881, \quad \boxed{E = E_A E_B = 0.669 \approx 67\%}.$$

Notes. The blank cells of the overflow column (35- and 65-mesh) mean no overflow was analysed above 28 mesh; they are not needed here, because the calculation uses the 10-mesh row only. The slide’s hand-written derivation has a term scribbled over; the answer is nevertheless fixed by the definitions E_A , E_B above, since $E = E_A E_B$ by definition and both are computed directly.

Q6 — Sieve analysis of a crushed solid

Tutorial 3 · slide 2 · 01-09-2026

Source: Tutorials/Tutorial 3.pptx, slide 2 (“Problem 1”)

“A crushed solid is subjected to a sieve analysis using a series of standard sieves. The following data are obtained:”

Sieve aperture / mm	4.00	3.00	2.00	1.50	1.00	0.75	0.50	Pan
Mass retained / g	20	45	80	110	140	105	70	30

Total 600 g. “Determine: 1. the differential screen analysis ... 2. the cumulative analysis, including (a) cumulative percentage retained (b) cumulative percentage passing. 3. Plot the differential and cumulative size-distribution curves. 4. Estimate the 50% passing particle size (D_{50}) using interpolation. 5. Calculate number of particles in each size fraction. 6. Calculate the specific surface area of the particles assuming: (a) particle density = 2500 kg/m³ (b) particles are approximately spherical (c) shape factor = 1.”

Method from the slides. Screen average size (Mod 1 Lec 1, slide 11): the mean of the two apertures that define an increment; cumulative analysis by consecutive addition (Mod 1 Lec 2, slide 16);

$$A_w = \frac{6}{\rho_p \Phi_s} \sum \frac{x_i}{\bar{D}_{pi}}, \quad N_i = \frac{x_i}{a \rho_p \bar{D}_{pi}^3} \text{ (particles per gram of sample)}$$

with a the volume shape factor and Φ_s the sphericity (Mod 1 Lec 1, slides 14–15).

Solution

1. Differential analysis. The mass retained on a sieve is the material between that aperture and the next coarser one, so each increment is characterised by the mean of the two apertures. The top fraction (retained on 4.00 mm)

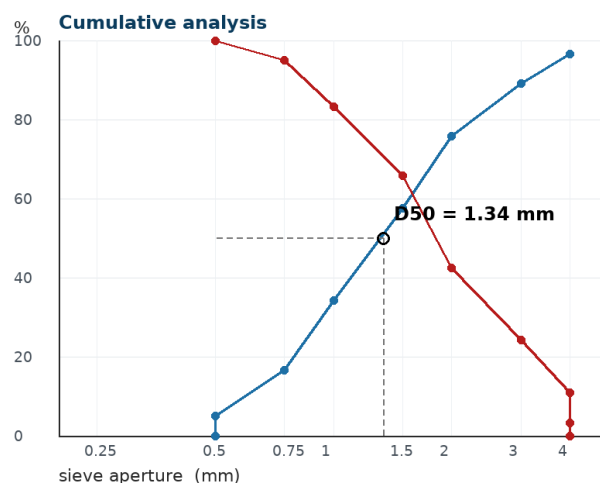
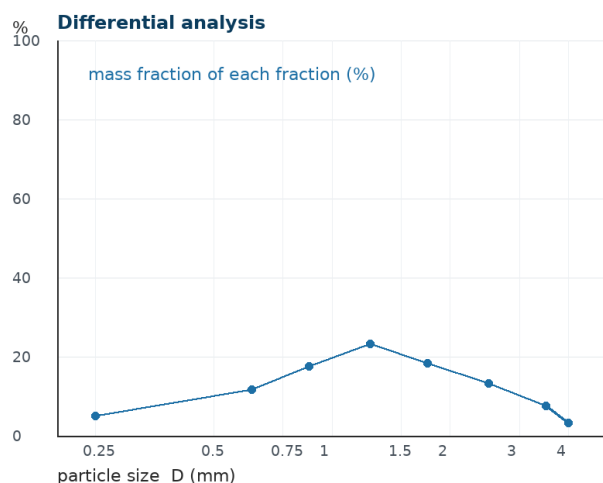
No.	aperture / mm	$\bar{D}_{pi}$ / mm	mass / g	x_i
1	4.00	4.000	20	0.0333
2	3.00	3.500	45	0.0750
3	2.00	2.500	80	0.1333
4	1.50	1.750	110	0.1833
5	1.00	1.250	140	0.2333
6	0.75	0.875	105	0.1750
7	0.50	0.625	70	0.1167
8	Pan	0.250	30	0.0500

has no coarser screen; its size is taken as 4.00 mm (see note).

on	% retained	% passing
4.00 mm	3.333	96.667
3.00 mm	10.833	89.167
2.00 mm	24.167	75.833
1.50 mm	42.500	57.500
1.00 mm	65.833	34.167
0.75 mm	83.333	16.667
0.50 mm	95.000	5.000
Pan	100.000	0.000

2. Cumulative analysis ($\sum x_i = 1.000$):

3. Curves. Both distributions, plotted from the two tables above (logarithmic size axis):



The differential curve peaks in the 1.50–1.00 mm increment, and the cumulative passing curve crosses 50% between 1.50 and 1.00 mm.

4. D_{50} by interpolation. Between the 1.50 mm and 1.00 mm apertures the passing percentage falls from 57.500 to 34.167, so

$$D_{50} = 1.50 - \frac{57.500 - 50.000}{57.500 - 34.167}(1.50 - 1.00) = 1.339 \text{ mm} \approx 1.34 \text{ mm}$$

(interpolating linearly on the logarithm of the aperture instead gives 1.32 mm — the two agree to the precision of the data).

5. Number of particles in each fraction. With spherical particles, $a = \pi/6 = 0.5236$, and $\rho_p = 2500 \text{ kg/m}^3 =$

$\bar{D}_{pi} / \text{mm}$	x_i	N_i in the 600 g sample	particles per gram	Total: 1.88×10^6 particles in the
4.000	0.0333	239	0.4	
3.500	0.0750	802	1.3	
2.500	0.1333	3911	6.5	
1.750	0.1833	15 680	26.1	
1.250	0.2333	54 760	91.3	
0.875	0.1750	119 737	199.6	
0.625	0.1167	219 038	365.1	
0.250	0.0500	1 466 772	2444.6	

600 g sample, i.e. about 3135 particles per gram. The count is dominated by the finest fraction, which holds 78% of all the particles but only 5% of the mass.

6. Specific surface area. With $\Phi_s = 1$ (spherical) and $\rho_p = 2.5 \times 10^{-3} \text{ g/mm}^3$:

$$\sum \frac{x_i}{\bar{D}_{pi}} = 0.96119 \text{ mm}^{-1}, \quad A_w = \frac{6}{(2.5 \times 10^{-3})(1)}(0.96119) = 2307 \text{ mm}^2/\text{g} = 23.1 \text{ cm}^2/\text{g} = 2.31 \text{ m}^2/\text{g}$$

The equivalent Sauter diameter of the whole sample is $\bar{D}_{vs} = 1/0.96119 = 1.04 \text{ mm}$.

1. Differential table above ($\sum x_i = 1.000$); 2. cumulative table above; 3. curves above; 4. $D_{50} = 1.34 \text{ mm}$; 5. particle counts above, total 1.88×10^6 in 600 g (≈ 3135 per gram); 6. $A_w = 2307 \text{ mm}^2/\text{g} = 2.31 \text{ m}^2/\text{g}$.

Notes.

- The aperture list is read as the sieve stack; the 20 g is the material retained on the 4.00 mm sieve, and the 30 g is the pan fraction below 0.50 mm. The size of the top fraction is not defined by the data (there is no coarser screen) and is taken here as 4.00 mm; it carries only 3.3% of the mass.
- “Shape factor = 1” is read as *sphericity* $\Phi_s = 1$, i.e. spherical particles, which is what the specific-surface formula needs. If the intended volume shape factor were instead $a = 1$ (cubes), the surface-area answer is unchanged but the particle counts fall by the factor 0.5236 (about 9.9×10^5 particles in 600 g).
- D_{50} depends on where it is read: linear interpolation on the passing curve gives 1.34 mm, interpolation on the logarithm of the aperture gives 1.32 mm.

Source: Tutorials/Tutorial 3.pptx, slide 3 (“Problem 2”)

“An irregular particle has a volume of $2.0 \times 10^{-9} \text{ m}^3$ and a surface area of $5.5 \times 10^{-6} \text{ m}^2$. Its characteristic diameter is 1.5 mm. Calculate the shape factor and the sphericity.”

Method from the slides (Mod 1 Lec 1, slides 9–15):

$$D_{ps} = \sqrt{\frac{s_p}{\pi}}, \quad D_{pv} = \left(\frac{6v_p}{\pi}\right)^{1/3}, \quad D_{vs} = \frac{6v_p}{s_p}, \quad \Phi_s = \frac{6v_p}{D_p s_p} = \frac{D_{vs}}{D_p}$$

with v_p the volume of one particle, s_p its surface area and D_p its nominal (characteristic) diameter.

Solution

With $v_p = 2.0 \times 10^{-9} \text{ m}^3$, $s_p = 5.5 \times 10^{-6} \text{ m}^2$, $D_p = 1.5 \text{ mm} = 1.5 \times 10^{-3} \text{ m}$:

Shape factor (volume shape factor, as used in Q1 and Q2):

$$a = \frac{v_p}{D_p^3} = \frac{2.0 \times 10^{-9}}{(1.5 \times 10^{-3})^3} = 0.593$$

Volume-surface (Sauter) diameter of the particle:

$$D_{vs} = \frac{6v_p}{s_p} = \frac{6(2.0 \times 10^{-9})}{5.5 \times 10^{-6}} = 2.18 \times 10^{-3} \text{ m} = 2.18 \text{ mm}$$

Sphericity by the relation on the slides:

$$\Phi_s = \frac{6v_p}{D_p s_p} = \frac{1.2 \times 10^{-8}}{(1.5 \times 10^{-3})(5.5 \times 10^{-6})} = 1.45$$

$$a = \frac{v_p}{D_p^3} = 0.59; \quad D_{vs} = \frac{6v_p}{s_p} = 2.18 \text{ mm}; \quad \Phi_s = \frac{6v_p}{D_p s_p} = 1.45.$$

Note — the printed data cannot be right. Sphericity is at most 1 by its definition (the sphere has the smallest surface area for a given volume), so $\Phi_s = 1.45$ is impossible. The figures imply that the sphere of the same volume (1.56 mm diameter) would have $7.68 \times 10^{-6} \text{ m}^2$ of surface, *more* than the $5.5 \times 10^{-6} \text{ m}^2$ quoted for the irregular particle. Check the numbers with the instructor — if the surface area is meant to be $5.5 \times 10^{-5} \text{ m}^2$, the same formula gives $\Phi_s = 0.145$.

Q8 — Crusher power when capacity and product size change

Tutorial 4 · slide 2 ·

07-09-2026

Source: Tutorials/Tutorial 4_7_9_2026.pptx, slide 2 (“Problem 1”)

“A certain crusher accepts the feed rock having a volume-surface mean diameter of 20 mm and discharges a product having a volume-surface mean diameter of 5 mm. The power required to crush 1200 kg/hr of material is 9.5 kW. What would be the power consumption if the capacity is reduced to 100 kg/hr and the product size to 4 mm? Assume mechanical efficiency to be same in both the cases.”

Method from the slides (Mod 1 Lec 5, slide 19). The feed and product are given as mean diameters, so the size-reduction laws that use mean diameters apply:

$$\text{Rittinger: } \frac{P}{\dot{m}} = K_R \left[\frac{1}{D_{Sb}} - \frac{1}{D_{Sa}} \right], \quad \text{Kick: } \frac{P}{\dot{m}} = K_K \ln \frac{D_{Sa}}{D_{Sb}}$$

with D_{Sa} the feed size and D_{Sb} the product size. Since the mechanical efficiency is the same in both duties, the constant (K_R or K_K) determined from the first duty carries over to the second.

Solution

First duty. $\dot{m}_1 = 1200 \text{ kg/h} = 1.2 \text{ t/h}$, so the specific energy is

$$\frac{P_1}{\dot{m}_1} = \frac{9.5}{1.2} = 7.9167 \text{ kW h/t}$$

With $D_{Sa} = 20 \text{ mm}$ and $D_{Sb} = 5 \text{ mm}$, the Rittinger size term is $\frac{1}{5} - \frac{1}{20} = 0.15/\text{mm}$, hence

$$K_R = \frac{7.9167}{0.15} = 52.78 \text{ kW h mm/t}$$

Second duty. The same feed (20 mm) is crushed to 4 mm at $\dot{m}_2 = 100 \text{ kg/h} = 0.1 \text{ t/h}$:

$$\frac{1}{4} - \frac{1}{20} = 0.20/\text{mm}, \quad P_2 = K_R \dot{m}_2 \left[\frac{1}{D_{Sb}} - \frac{1}{D_{Sa}} \right] = (52.78)(0.1)(0.20) = 1.06 \text{ kW}$$

$K_R = 52.78 \text{ kW h mm/t}$; $P_2 = 1.06 \text{ kW}$ for 100 kg/h to 4 mm (Rittinger’s law).

Notes.

- The question does not name the law. Rittinger’s is used because the data are mean diameters, which is how the lecture’s crusher problem (Q4) is set up. If Kick’s law is intended instead, $K_K = 7.9167 / \ln(20/5) = 5.711 \text{ kW h/t}$ and $P_2 = 5.711 \ln(20/4)(0.1) = 0.92 \text{ kW}$.
- Bond’s law cannot be applied to these data as they stand: it needs the work index W_i and the 80%-passing sizes, neither of which is given here.

Q9 — Energy per kg of material

Tutorial 4 · slide 3 · 07-09-2026

Source: Tutorials/Tutorial 4_7_9_2026.pptx, slide 3 (“Problem 2”, printed inside a picture on the slide)

“A material is crushed from an initial particle size of 10 mm to a final size of 2 mm. If the Kick’s constant is 5 kJ/kg, calculate the energy required per kg of material.”

Method from the slides (Mod 1 Lec 5, slide 19):

$$\frac{E}{m} = K_K \ln \frac{D_{Sa}}{D_{Sb}}$$

Solution

$$\ln \frac{10}{2} = \ln 5 = 1.6094, \quad \frac{E}{m} = 5 \times 1.6094 = 8.05 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

$$\frac{E}{m} = 8.05 \text{ kJ/kg (i.e. 8.05 kJ for every kg crushed).}$$

Q10 — Mixing index of a binary solid mixture

Quiz-1 · 03-09-2026 · 10 marks

Source: Tests/Quiz1_Soln.pdf, page 1 (question) and page 2 (the instructor's sample solution)

“A binary solid mixture consists of Component A and Component B. The overall composition of A in the mixture is 50% by mass. Samples are withdrawn from different locations after mixing. Each sample has a total mass of 100 g, and the mass of Component A in each sample is measured as follows:”

Sample	mass of A / g	Sample	mass of A / g	Sample	mass of A / g	Sample	mass of A / g
1	52	4	45	7	54	10	50
2	48	5	51	8	46		
3	55	6	49	9	50		

“Assuming each 100-g sample contains 1000 particles. Calculate the mixing index.”

Method from the slides (Mod 1 Lec 4, slides 16–18):

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^N x_i^2 - \bar{x} \sum_{i=1}^N x_i}{N-1}}, \quad \sigma_0 = \sqrt{\mu(1-\mu)}, \quad I_s = \frac{\sigma_0}{s}$$

with x_i the mass fraction of A in each sample and μ the overall mass fraction of A.

Solution

The mass fractions are $x_i = 0.52, 0.48, 0.55, 0.45, 0.51, 0.49, 0.54, 0.46, 0.50, 0.50$;

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{i=1}^{10} x_i &= 5.0000, & \sum_{i=1}^{10} x_i^2 &= 2.5092, & \bar{x} &= 0.5000 \\ s &= \sqrt{\frac{2.5092 - (0.5)(5.0)}{10-1}} = \sqrt{\frac{0.0092}{9}} = 0.03197 \\ \sigma_0 &= \sqrt{0.5 \times 0.5} = 0.50, & I_s &= \frac{\sigma_0}{s} = \frac{0.50}{0.03197} = 15.6 \end{aligned}$$

$$\bar{x} = 0.5000; \quad s = 0.0320; \quad \sigma_0 = 0.50; \quad \boxed{I_s = 15.6}.$$

The sample solution in the file rounds s to 0.031 and reports $I_s = 0.5/0.031 = 16.1$; the difference is only that rounding. Two variants, for completeness: with the N denominator $s = 0.03033$ and $I_s = 16.5$; if the 1000 particles per sample are used in the granular form $\sigma_e = \sqrt{\mu_p(1-\mu_p)/n} = \sqrt{0.25/1000} = 0.0158$, then $I_s = \sigma_e/s = 0.49$, which is the form used for non-cohesive granular solids on slide 17. The mixture here is sampled by mass and the question gives a mass composition, so the mass-based σ_0 of slide 18 is the one used above.

Q11 — Bond work index and power for a finer product Tutorial Test 1 · 07-09-2026 · 15 marks

Source: Tests/TT1_Solution.pdf, page 1 (question) and pages 1–2 (the instructor's solution)

“320 kW of power is required to crush 140 tonnes/h of a material. If 80% of the feed passes through a 50-mm screen and 80% of the product passes through a 2-mm screen, calculate the work index of the material. What will be the power required for the same feed at 140 tonnes/h to be crushed to a product such that 80% is to pass through a 1.6-mm screen?”

Method from the slides (Mod 1 Lec 5). Bond's law as given on slide 19, with the work index defined on slide 17 as the energy needed to take a very large feed to a product 80% passing 100 μm :

$$\frac{P}{\dot{m}} = 0.3162 W_i \left[\frac{1}{\sqrt{D_{pb}}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{D_{pa}}} \right] \quad (D \text{ in mm, } P/\dot{m} \text{ in kW h/t})$$

Solution

1. Work index from the first duty. $\dot{m}_1 = 140 \text{ t/h}$, so

$$\frac{P_1}{\dot{m}_1} = \frac{320}{140} = 2.2857 \text{ kW h/t}$$

Here $D_{pa} = 50 \text{ mm}$ and $D_{pb} = 2 \text{ mm}$ (the 80%-passing sizes):

$$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{50}} = 0.70711 - 0.14142 = 0.56569$$

$$W_i = \frac{2.2857}{0.3162 \times 0.56569} = 12.78 \text{ kW h/t}$$

2. Power for the finer product. Now $D_{pb} = 1.6 \text{ mm}$ at the same feed (50 mm) and the same 140 tonnes/h:

$$\frac{1}{\sqrt{1.6}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{50}} = 0.79057 - 0.14142 = 0.64915$$

$$\frac{P_2}{\dot{m}} = 0.3162(12.78)(0.64915) = 2.623 \text{ kW h/t}, \quad P_2 = 2.623 \times 140 = 367.2 \text{ kW}$$

$$W_i = 12.78 \text{ kW h/t}; \quad \boxed{P_2 = 367.2 \text{ kW}} \text{ (specific energy 2.62 kW h/t).}$$

This agrees with the boxed values in the instructor's solution (12.78 and 367.22 kW). Note that the 320 kW is the total power drawn; unlike Q4, no empty-mill allowance is given here, so no deduction is made.

Questions, data and methods: the uploaded files listed under each question. Arithmetic: every number above is reproduced by `sp2-answers-check.py` in this folder, which is the record of the calculations. Where a source is silent or contradicts itself, the note under that solution says so.